

UNIT 3 / People and things

A thing, or no thing

Your goal: Use ein, eine, kein and keine to identify objects.

01 Learn the idea

For a singular subject or after Das ist, use ein with masculine and neuter nouns and eine with feminine nouns: ein Tisch, ein Buch, eine Lampe. These mean a or an. There is no ordinary plural indefinite article: Das sind Bücher means those are books.

Kein negates an indefinite noun: Das ist kein Buch means that is not a book. Use keine for feminine singular and basic plural: keine Lampe, keine Bücher. Compare the noun's article before choosing the ending. Do not use nicht ein as your default translation of not a when kein is the straightforward choice.

Words and phrases

German	English
ein Buch	a book
eine Lampe	a lamp
kein Tisch	not a table
keine Bücher	no books
Das ist kein Handy.	That is not a mobile phone.

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Ben

Ist das ein Handy?

Is that a mobile phone?

Mia

Nein, das ist kein Handy. Das ist ein Buch.

No, that is not a mobile phone. That is a book.

Ben

Und das ist eine Lampe.

And that is a lamp.

Your real-life mission

Write four object identifications, two true and two deliberately false. Correct the false ones using *kein* or *keine*.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “ein Buch” mean?

- A. a lamp
- B. not a table
- C. a book

2. What does “eine Lampe” mean?

- A. a lamp
- B. not a table
- C. no books

3. What does “kein Tisch” mean?

- A. no books
- B. not a table
- C. That is not a mobile phone.

4. Complete: Das ist ____ Lampe.

- A. ein
- B. eine
- C. einen

5. What is the first object really?

- A. A phone
- B. A lamp
- C. A book

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. C - a book

“ein Buch” means “a book”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. A - a lamp

“eine Lampe” means “a lamp”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. B - not a table

“kein Tisch” means “not a table”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - eine

Lampe is feminine, so its indefinite nominative article is eine.

5. C - A book

Mia corrects Ben and says Das ist ein Buch.

One possible mission response

Das ist ein Buch. Das ist keine Lampe. Das ist kein Tisch. Das ist eine Tasche.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

Open your interactive course at <https://everygyan.com/learn-german>. Free additional A1 practice: <https://www.goethe.de/prj/dfd/en/home.cfm>

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